

Safety Knife Checkout System

Standard Operating Procedure Procedimiento Operativo Estándar

Scope	Checking out, returning, cleaning, and inspecting numbered food-production safety knives.
Applies to	Operators, Sanitation, QA, and Managers (Admins).
Everyday use	The kiosk on the shared iPad (landscape). No sign-in required.
Management	Fleet board, Reports, and Admin panel — admins and QA only .
Records	Every action writes an immutable audit entry (who, what, when).

Why this matters

A knife must never go back into food production without being cleaned and inspected. The system enforces that order — it is impossible to check out a knife that has not been cleaned and passed inspection.

Contents

1	The knife lifecycle at a glance
2	Roles and PINs
3	Return policy — when a knife is due back
4	Using the kiosk (everyday floor use)
5	Reading the kiosk board
6	Sanitation: cleaning and inspection checklist
7	Damaged knives — manager review
8	Manager tasks on the fleet board
9	Reports
10	Advanced: every admin setting and what it does
11	Troubleshooting

1. The knife lifecycle at a glance

Each knife moves through a fixed sequence. The system blocks any step taken out of order.

Stage	Who	What happens
Available	—	Clean, inspected, and ready to use.
Checked out	Operator	In use. The knife shows who has it and when it is due back.
Awaiting sanitation	Operator returns it	Used knife waiting to be cleaned. It cannot be checked out again in this state.
Available (again)	Sanitation	Cleaned and inspected, condition Good → returns to service.
Damaged	Sanitation flags it	Held out of service with a reason (and optional photo) until a manager reviews it.
Out of service	Admin/QA retires it	Removed from rotation (lost, broken, replaced).

Overdue is not a separate stage — any checked-out knife past its due time is flagged overdue automatically, turns red, and appears in the banner at the top of the kiosk.

2. Roles and PINs

Every employee has a short PIN (4–8 digits) that identifies them. The PIN determines what they are allowed to do. One person can hold more than one role.

Role	Can do
Operator	Check out an available knife; check in the knife they checked out.
Sanitation	Clean and inspect used knives, returning good ones to service or flagging damage.
QA	View the fleet board, reports, and admin panel (supervisory access).
Admin (Manager)	Everything above, plus return damaged knives to service, manage knives and employees, and configure the system.

Change the default PINs before going live

A new installation ships with sample accounts — Admin **0000**, Operator **1111**, Sanitation **2222**, QA **3333**. Set real PINs in Admin → Workers on day one, and remove the samples you do not need. PINs are stored encrypted and cannot be read back — if one is forgotten, a manager sets a new one.

3. Return policy — when a knife is due back

The knife's type sets its due date automatically at checkout.

Knife type	Kiosk color	Must be returned
Food Contact (FC)	Blue tile	Same day , by the end of the shift.
Non-Food Contact (NFC)	Silver tile	End of the week — due Friday, end of shift.

The policy is printed at the top of the kiosk in English and Spanish. When an employee checks a knife out, the confirmation screen shows the exact date and time it is due back, and that time then appears on the knife's tile.

4. Using the kiosk (everyday floor use)

The kiosk is the shared iPad on the floor. It needs no sign-in — every action is confirmed with the employee's own PIN, which is what records who did it.

Checking a knife out — Operator

- 1 Tap the knife you want. It must have a **green ring** (Available).
- 2 Enter your PIN and tap **Next / Siguiente**.
- 3 Your name appears. Confirm it is you — tap **Yes, that's me / Sí**. (If it is not your name, tap **Not me** and try again.)
- 4 The screen shows when the knife is **due back**. The tile now shows your name at the top and a yellow ring.

Checking a knife in — Operator

- 1 Tap your knife (yellow ring, your name on it).
- 2 Enter your PIN, tap **Next**, and confirm your name.
- 3 The knife moves to **Awaiting sanitation** (orange ring). You are done — do not put it back into service yourself.

Only the person who checked a knife out (or a manager) can check it back in. This keeps returns attributed to the right person.

Cleaning and returning to service — Sanitation

- 1 Tap a knife with an **orange ring** (Awaiting sanitation).
- 2 Enter your PIN, tap **Next**, confirm your name, and tap **Yes — continue / Sí**.
- 3 Answer the four inspection questions (next section).
- 4 Tap **Submit / Enviar**.

5. Reading the kiosk board

Every knife is a tile. The **fill color** tells you the knife type; the **ring around the tile** tells you its status.

Ring color	Status	What to do
Green	Available	Ready to check out.
Yellow	Checked out	In use — the holder's name is shown at the top of the tile, with the due-back time.
Orange	Awaiting sanitation	Sanitation needs to clean and inspect it.
Red + "OVERDUE"	Overdue	Past its due time. Track it down and return it now.
Red (rose)	Damaged — needs manager	Out of use until a manager reviews it.
Gray	Out of service	Retired from the fleet.

The counts along the top show how many knives are in each state. If anything is overdue, a red banner lists those knife numbers. Each tile also shows the knife number, and the type spelled out along the bottom.

6. Sanitation: cleaning and inspection checklist

Before any used knife can go back into production, sanitation must answer all four questions. Every prompt is shown in English and Spanish.

#	Question	Notes
1	Cleaned? / ¿Limpiado?	Yes or No.
2	Inspected? / ¿Inspeccionado?	Yes or No.
3	Condition / Condición	Good / Bueno — or — Damaged / Dañado.
4	If damaged, why? / ¿Por qué está dañado?	Required when Damaged. A photo can be attached with the iPad camera (optional but recommended).

The rule the system enforces

A knife returns to service **only** if it is marked cleaned **and** inspected **and** its condition is Good. If either answer is No, the system refuses to return it to service.

7. Damaged knives — manager review

When sanitation marks a knife **Damaged**, the knife is immediately held out of service. Sanitation cannot return it, and it cannot be checked out.

- The reported reason (and photo, if taken) is saved to the knife.
- If Teams alerts are switched on, a message is posted to the channel right away so a manager knows.
- A **manager (Admin)** reviews it on the fleet board: tap the knife, read **Reported damage**, view the photo, then either **Return to service (manager)** or **Retire (out of service)**.

8. Manager tasks on the fleet board

The fleet board at / is for admins and QA. Sign in with your PIN. Tap any knife to open its action panel.

Action	Who	When it appears
Check out / Return (mark used)	Operator (admins included)	Same lifecycle actions as the kiosk.

Action	Who	When it appears
Clean & return to service	Sanitation (admins included)	Knife is awaiting sanitation.
Return to service (manager)	Admin only	Knife is Damaged — clears the damage note and photo.
Retire (out of service)	Admin / QA	Any knife not already retired. Use for lost or broken knives.
Restore to fleet	Admin / QA	Knife is out of service.
Change knife type (FC / NFC)	Admin / QA	Always — changes future due dates. Logged.
View full history	Admin / QA	Opens that knife's complete lifecycle record.

Use the filter chips above the grid to show only one status. When viewing **Awaiting sanitation**, sanitation staff and admins get a **Select multiple** button to clean several knives at once.

9. Reports

/reports (admins and QA) answers the end-of-shift questions.

Panel	What it tells you
Still checked out	How many knives are out right now, and how many are overdue.
Total checkouts	Lifetime usage count.
Avg turnaround	Average time from a knife being returned to it being cleaned and back in service.
Cleanings	Total number of cleaning cycles recorded.
End-of-day sweep	A table of every knife still out — who has it, since when, when it is due, and whether it is overdue. Work this list before shift close.
Most-used knives	Highest-use blades — useful for spotting wear.

10. Advanced: every admin setting and what it does

The Admin panel is at **/admin**, open to admins and QA. If you are already signed in on the fleet board, no second PIN is needed. The header has a **light/dark mode** toggle and a link back to the fleet.

Knives

Setting	What it does
Add a knife	Adds a new knife to the fleet by number, with its type (Food Contact or Non-Food Contact). It enters as Available. Numbers must be unique.

Setting	What it does
Knife fleet list	Every knife with its type and current status.
Search (knives)	Filters the list by number, type (FC/NFC or full name), or status (e.g. “awaiting sanitation”).
Edit (per knife)	Change a knife's number or type. Logged to the audit trail.
Remove (per knife)	Permanently deletes the knife and its history. Intended for a knife added by mistake. Blocked while the knife is checked out. To take a real knife out of rotation and keep its history, use Retire on the board instead.

Workers

Setting	What it does
Add a worker	Creates an employee: name, PIN (4–8 digits, must be unique), and one or more roles.
Bulk upload (CSV)	Adds many employees at once from a CSV with columns name,pin,roles (roles separated by ; — e.g. OPERATOR;SANITATION). Rows with a duplicate or invalid PIN are skipped and reported.
Download sample CSV	A correctly formatted example file to fill in.
Employees list	All employees, sorted by role: Admin, QA, Operator, Sanitation.
Search (employees)	Filters the list by name or role.
Export employees (CSV)	Downloads name, roles, and active status. PINs are encrypted and cannot be exported.
Edit (per employee)	Change their name, roles, or set a new PIN (leave PIN blank to keep the current one).
Deactivate / Reactivate	Revokes or restores access while keeping the person's history. Use this when someone leaves.
Remove (per employee)	Deletes the employee record entirely. Prefer Deactivate to preserve the audit trail.

Advanced section (collapsed by default)

Click **Advanced** to expand. These are setup settings — you should rarely need to change them day to day.

Microsoft Teams notifications

Setting	What it does
Webhook URL	Where alerts are posted. Create it in Teams: channel > “...” menu > Workflows → “Post to a channel when a webhook request is received”, then paste the URL it generates (it contains <i>logic.azure.com</i>). Older “Incoming Webhook” connector URLs also work.

Setting	What it does
Enable Teams notifications	Master on/off switch. Nothing is sent while this is off.
Notify: knife flagged damaged	Posts the moment sanitation reports damage, so a manager can review. <i>On by default.</i>
Notify: knife goes overdue	Intended for the end-of-day overdue sweep. Requires a scheduled job to run the sweep; the preference is stored and ready.
Notify: knife checked out	Posts each checkout, including the due-back time. <i>Off by default.</i>
Notify: knife checked in	Posts each check-in. <i>Off by default.</i>
Notify: cleaned & returned to service	Posts each completed cleaning. <i>Off by default.</i>
Save	Stores the settings. If notifications are enabled, a valid https URL and at least one alert type are required.
Send test message	Posts a test line to the channel so you can confirm the connection before relying on it. Errors report exactly what Teams returned.

Per-action alerts (checkout / check-in / cleaned) get chatty on a busy floor — that is why they start switched off.

Kiosk logo

Setting	What it does
Choose File	Uploads your company logo, shown in the top-left corner of the kiosk board. PNG, JPG, or SVG under 500 KB.
Remove logo	Clears it; the kiosk falls back to the knife icon.

System (read-only)

Reading	What it means
Timezone	The timezone all due dates are calculated in — “end of day” and “end of Friday” follow this clock. Set by the TZ environment variable on the server (e.g. America/New_York). If this is wrong, due times will be wrong.
Server time now	The system's current time in that timezone. Compare it against a clock on the wall to confirm the setting is right.

Recent activity (audit log)

Setting	What it does
Activity table	The most recent actions: when, which knife, what happened, who did it, and any note (including the sanitation answers).
Export full log (CSV)	Downloads the complete audit history for food-safety audits or a recall investigation. Records are never edited or deleted.

11. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause and fix
"PIN not recognized."	Wrong PIN, or the employee is deactivated. A manager can set a new PIN in Admin → Workers.
"This action requires the SANITATION role."	The PIN entered does not hold the role that action needs — e.g. an operator trying to clean. Use the right person's PIN, or have a manager add the role.
Knife was checked out by someone else	Only the person holding a knife (or a manager) can check it in. A manager can return it on the fleet board.
A knife cannot be checked out	It is not Available — it is awaiting sanitation, damaged, or retired. Follow the ring color.
Due dates look wrong by hours	The server timezone is off. Check Admin → Advanced → System and set the TZ environment variable.
Teams test says HTTP 405	The URL pasted is not a webhook (usually a link to the channel). Create a Workflows webhook as described in section 10.
Teams says nothing posted	Check Enable Teams notifications is on and at least one alert type is ticked, then use Send test message .
Kiosk shows old information	The board refreshes itself every few seconds; if it looks stuck, reload the page on the iPad.

Daily rhythm — the short version

Operators check knives out and back in at the kiosk. Sanitation cleans and inspects everything orange. Before shift close, a manager opens **Reports** → **End-of-day sweep** and chases down anything still out. Damaged knives wait for a manager.